

Psalms 122

I Was Glad

I was glad when they said unto me, Let us go into the house of the Lord
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *I was glad when they said unto me, Let us go into the house of the LORD.*
- 2 *Our feet shall stand within thy gates, O Jerusalem.*
- 3 *Jerusalem is builded as a city that is compact together:*
- 4 *Whither the tribes go up, the tribes of the LORD, unto the testimony of Israel, to give thanks unto the name of the LORD.*
- 5 *For there are set thrones of judgment, the thrones of the house of David.*
- 6 *Pray for the peace of Jerusalem: they shall prosper that love thee.*
- 7 *Peace be within thy walls, and prosperity within thy palaces.*
- 8 *For my brethren and companions' sakes, I will now say, Peace be within thee.*
- 9 *Because of the house of the LORD our God I will seek thy good.*

2 · CONTEXT

Psalms 122 captures the specific joy of arrival—pilgrims finally standing within Jerusalem's gates after a long ascent, marveling at the city's unity, its role as the seat of judgment and covenant testimony, and its status as the center of shared worship. Attributed to David, it moves naturally from personal gladness to a deliberate prayer for the city's peace, modeling love of a place tied to love of the people and worship it hosts. Henry notes the psalm's balance of delight and duty: gladness in arriving is matched by responsibility to pray for the place once there.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

The psalm opens with remembered gladness at the invitation itself—let us go to the house of the Lord—followed by the satisfaction of finally standing within Jerusalem's gates, anticipation now fulfilled in actual arrival.

Verse 3-5

The city is admired as compactly built, unified rather than scattered, the place where the tribes—the tribes of the Lord—go up according to a testimony given to Israel, to give thanks to His name. Jerusalem's civic and spiritual significance are named together: thrones of judgment, the throne of the house of David, are located there as well.

Verse 6-9

A direct exhortation follows: pray for the peace of Jerusalem, with the promise that those who love her shall prosper. Peace within her walls and prosperity within her palaces are requested specifically for the sake of others—brethren and companions—and for the sake of the house of the Lord, personal motive folded into worship of God rather than kept separate from it.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Joy in arriving at a place of worship is meant to lead naturally into ongoing responsibility for that place's welfare, not remain a passing emotional high. Praying for peace in a specific location, motivated by love for both the people who dwell there and the worship it hosts, models how personal gladness and communal duty belong together.

Application for life today.

Recall the last time gathering for worship genuinely made you glad, as verse 1 describes, and consider whether that gladness has led to any ongoing prayer or care for that community, or faded once the moment passed. Practice praying specifically for the peace of a place—your church, city, or community—rather than only for your private concerns, following the psalm's deliberate turn from personal joy to communal petition. Notice how verses 8–9 tie love for people ('my brethren and companions') directly to love for God's house; examine whether your own care for a worshiping community includes both.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. When was the last time gathering for worship made you genuinely glad, as verse 1 describes, and has that gladness led anywhere beyond the moment itself?
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2. What specific community or place of worship in your life needs the kind of deliberate prayer for peace that this psalm calls for in verses 6–7?
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3. How does the psalm's pairing of love for people ('my brethren and companions') and love for God's house (vv. 8–9) challenge you to hold both together rather than one without the other?
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Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, *Commentary on the Whole Bible* (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).